

Nothing Phone 3a

A Phone That Looks as Different as It Feels

The Nothing Phone 3a dares to be different with its signature transparent back and refined Glyph Interface. It brings meaningful upgrades, from a glass-backed design for enhanced durability to a versatile triple-camera system and a well-optimized Snapdragon 7s Gen 3 chipset. When paired with Nothing OS 3.1, you get a minimal yet feature-rich Android experience. But does it do enough to stand out in the competitive sub-₹25K segment?

DESIGN

In a world where most phones look basically identical, the Nothing Phone 3a stands out like nothing else on the shelves. The packaging is minimal and 100% plastic-free. That transparent back showing off the internals isn't just a gimmick anymore. The design has become synonymous with the brand across its entire product lineup.

The Phone 3a continues Nothing's trademark aesthetic but with a meaningful upgrade as they've switched from polycarbonate to glass for the back panel, making it more durable but less slippery than the 2a. It also gets an improved IP64 rating, making it dust-proof and resistant to water splashes. Though it is not entirely water-proof, it can handle daily life better than previous models.

The Phone 3a series has a substantial presence in the hand. At 201g for the standard model and 211g for the Pro, these aren't lightweight devices, but the weight is well-distributed, at least on the non-Pro model. Both models measure 163.52mm tall and 77.5mm wide, with the Pro being marginally thicker at 8.39mm compared to the 3a's 8.35mm.



The build quality feels impressive, which is a definite upgrade from previous Nothing phones. While the phone feels premium with its glass back, the chassis is actually made of polycarbonate + 20% glass fibre. It feels good in the hand, but it's definitely prone to damage, especially if it falls on a hard surface. In my case, it fell on the concrete and immediately chipped the mid-frame.

The slightly taller display with less rounded corners shows a more mature, confident design language for Nothing's second-generation of mid-range phones.

The star of the show remains the Glyph Interface, which is comprised of three distinctive LED light strips on the back. On the 3a, they frame the

new triple camera system beautifully. The Phone 3a extends the camera module we saw on the 2a into a row of three cameras.

A standout feature during setup is introducing you to the Essential Key, which is a dedicated physical button on the right side that integrates with Nothing's new AI-powered hub called Essential Space. We'll talk more about that later, but it's clear that Nothing wants this to be an essential part of the user experience.

DISPLAY

The 6.77-inch AMOLED display with 120Hz refresh rate is immediately striking. It's got that AMOLED pop we all love with super vibrant colours, and the bezels are thin enough that the content looks really immersive.

In our display tests using Calman and Spectral C6 Colorimeter, the screen on the 3a went up to 2300 nits of peak brightness in the adaptive mode, which means you get great sun-light legibility.

When it comes to colour accuracy, the 3a has an average delta E of 1.4 in the Standard colour profile, meaning you can expect brilliant colours across YouTube, OTT apps and more. The 3a's display covers 98.4% of the sRGB colour space and perfectly balances the blue, red and green colours.

This is one of the best screens you get on a phone in the sub-25K segment, the only thing missing now is a version with a matte screen, which I feel will go very well with the Nothing OS aesthetics.

PERFORMANCE

The Snapdragon 7s Gen 3 isn't the absolute top chip out there but is a significant upgrade from the Phone 2a, with the CPU being up to 33% faster.

In daily use, this translates to snappy app launches and smooth multitasking. Nothing OS has been optimised for over 440 typical mobile tasks, and it shows when apps launch quickly and stay ready in the background for faster switching.